

STEVEN WATKINS

Denver, CO · stevenwatkinsphotography.com · untelevised.media/author/radical-edward [LinkedIn] · [email] · [phone]

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Founding Editor in Chief and media technology leader with 13+ years of experience building independent news operations from the ground up — including full-stack web platforms, custom live streaming infrastructure, video production pipelines, and editorial teams. Proven ability to architect and deploy the technical systems that underpin modern video journalism, from field-to-studio broadcast infrastructure to CMS-driven publishing platforms. Classically trained photographer and videographer with frontline experience covering civil unrest, protests, and breaking news for international wire services and alternative media outlets.

Seeking to bring a rare combination of editorial vision, technical depth, and hands-on production experience to the founding Director role at Deep South Today Studios.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Video & Broadcast Infrastructure

- Live streaming architecture (NGINX-based RTMP/HLS field-to-studio pipelines)
- Field videography & photojournalism (breaking news, civil unrest, conflict coverage)
- Studio and remote production workflows
- Multi-platform content distribution (social, web, broadcast)

Technical & Engineering

- Full-stack web development (React, Next.js, Node.js, Python)
- CMS architecture & schema design (Sanity, WordPress, custom platforms)
- DevOps, server management, caching optimization (NGINX, CDN)
- API integrations, automation, content management systems

Editorial & Leadership

- Newsroom operations & editorial strategy
 - Team management & cross-functional coordination
 - Source development & investigative research
 - Digital branding, social media strategy, audience growth
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Editor in Chief

UnTelevised Media — Denver, CO · untelevised.media *January 2019 – Present*

Founded and operate an independent digital news outlet covering political climate, civil unrest, government accountability, international conflict, and environmental issues. Built the entire operation — editorial, technical, and distribution — from the ground up.

- Architected and deployed a custom NGINX-based live streaming infrastructure enabling high-quality field-to-studio broadcasts, modeling the same production workflows used by Reuters and AP for wire service live feeds
- Led website evolution through three full platform iterations: WordPress → custom MERN stack → Next.js with Sanity CMS, maintaining continuous publication through each migration
- Designed and implemented a headless CMS (Sanity) with custom schema, editorial workflow, and automated content pipeline for a daily-updated news site producing original reporting
- Built a real-time news ticker system using GROK query language, automatically extracting headlines from published content and syndicating across both the website header and live broadcast overlays — demonstrating code reuse across web and video platforms
- Manage a distributed team of contributors including an on-the-ground correspondent in Gaza producing field reports
- Oversee all editorial operations: story selection, source verification, fact-checking, publication workflow, and social media distribution across multiple platforms
- Produced original investigative and breaking news coverage including on-the-ground reporting of civil unrest, police violence, protest movements, and international conflicts

Selected Coverage:

- Investigated neo-Nazi militia infiltration of martial arts schools across Middle Tennessee (Active Clubs / Patriot Front)
- Breaking news coverage of ICE enforcement actions, deportation fatalities, and immigrant detention protests
- Gaza genocide reporting with on-the-ground correspondent producing field dispatches from Rafah
- Civil unrest coverage: World Cup worker strikes, anti-ICE protests, Madison police shooting protests
- International reporting: Albania's anti-Kushner uprising, Yemen conflict escalation, Ukraine domestic protests

Senior Developer / Digital Media Strategist

A.R. Media Group — Washington, D.C. *November 2013 – March 2019*

Founding member of an independent media consortium operating a network of news sites covering political corruption, civil liberties, corporate accountability, and environmental issues. Sites included anonresistance.news, thefifthcolumn.com, antimedia.com, and freethoughtproject.org.

- Led web development and management for 23 media outlets and partner organizations within the media group network
- Designed and implemented a comprehensive back-end content distribution platform enabling seamless cross-publication content sharing and editorial collaboration across multiple outlets
- Produced time-sensitive promotional and educational video content on complex political and social subjects
- Orchestrated full digital branding and social media strategy for the media group network, including logo design, motion graphics, and visual identity systems

- Managed server infrastructure, content delivery, and technical operations across the publication network

Freelance Videographer & Photographer

Various Assignments — U.S. & International *2015 – Present*

- Covered protests, civil unrest, and breaking news events as a freelance videographer for international wire services and independent media, including Ruptly/RT and Al Jazeera
- Produced frontline video and photography during dangerous and fast-moving events, including protest coverage and civil disobedience actions
- Trained in breaking news videography and field safety by experienced Ruptly correspondents and independent conflict journalists (Ford Fischer, News2Share)
- Classically trained in photography by Marion L. Brown, lifelong black-and-white landscape photographer; specializing in natural landscapes and authentic photojournalistic moments

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript/TypeScript, Python, PHP, SQL (PostgreSQL), GROQ **Frameworks:** React, Next.js, Express, Node.js, Sanity CMS, WordPress **Infrastructure:** NGINX, RTMP/HLS streaming, Linux server administration, CDN management, caching optimization **Video/Photo:** Adobe Premiere Pro, DaVinci Resolve, Adobe Lightroom/Photoshop, live streaming platforms, field camera equipment **Other:** Git, CI/CD, REST APIs, content distribution systems, social media management tools

EDUCATION

[Institution] — [Degree, Field] [Year]

REFERENCES

Available upon request.